

ONE HUNDRED NINTH LEGISLATURE

FIRST SESSION

LEGISLATIVE RESOLUTION 144

Introduced by Kauth, 31.

PURPOSE: The purpose of this resolution is to propose an interim study to examine potential changes to Nebraska's teacher certification requirements to create an apprenticeship-based pathway for individuals with equivalent education and professional experience who seek to transition into kindergarten through grade twelve teaching.

Nebraska faces ongoing challenges in attracting and retaining qualified educators, particularly in rural and high-need school districts, and the traditional teacher certification process may present barriers for individuals with equivalent education and professional experience in other fields who seek to transition into the teaching profession later in their careers. Alternative pathways to certification, including onsite apprenticeship programs conducted by school districts, may provide opportunities to increase the number of qualified teachers while maintaining high-quality standards for Nebraska schools. Such apprenticeship programs would focus on pedagogical training, classroom management, and other essential instructional skills to ensure competency and effectiveness in teaching. The State Board of Education plays a critical role in establishing standards and oversight mechanisms for teacher certification programs, including alternative pathways such as school district led apprenticeships.

This interim study is meant to examine potential changes to Nebraska's teacher certification requirements to allow individuals with equivalent education and experience to enter the teaching profession through an apprenticeship-based pathway conducted by school districts. Such study shall include, but need not be limited to:

- (1) An evaluation of existing barriers within Nebraska's current teacher

certification process that may hinder professionals from transitioning into teaching;

(2) An examination of best practices from other states that have implemented alternative certification pathways, including apprenticeship programs;

(3) An assessment of the pedagogical and classroom management training necessary to maintain high-quality instructional standards in an apprenticeship program;

(4) A determination of the role of school districts in designing and implementing apprenticeship programs for prospective teachers;

(5) An examination of the process by which the State Board of Education would approve school district apprenticeship programs and ensure alignment of such programs with state educational standards;

(6) An investigation of the criteria and process by which individuals completing an apprenticeship program would be certified as teachers in Nebraska;

(7) Consideration of the potential impact of an apprenticeship pathway on addressing teacher shortages in critical subject areas and geographic regions;

(8) An identification of any statutory or regulatory changes necessary to implement such an apprenticeship pathway; and

(9) Input from relevant stakeholders, including representatives from the State Department of Education, the State Board of Education, school district administrators, teacher preparation programs, educators, and other interested parties.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MEMBERS OF THE ONE HUNDRED NINTH LEGISLATURE OF NEBRASKA, FIRST SESSION:

1. That the Education Committee of the Legislature shall be designated to conduct an interim study to carry out the purposes of this resolution.

2. That the committee shall upon the conclusion of its study make a report of its findings, together with its recommendations, to the Legislative Council or Legislature.